

Implementing Lambdas with Substitution

CS 350

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Broad Strategy

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 - How to substitute within functions/calls
 - How to interpret functions/calls

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Syntax and Parsing

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 - `{lam x body}` is anonymous function with argument `x` and body `body`
 - `lam` instead of `lambda` to distinguish Curly vs Flit

```
(define (parse s-exp)
  (cond
    ....
    [(s-exp-match? `{lam {SYMBOL} ANY} s)
     (lamS (s-exp->symbol
              (first (s-exp->list
                      (second (s-exp->list s)))))
            (parse (third (s-exp->list s))))))])
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```
(define-type Exp
  ....
  (lamE [arg : Symbol]
        [body : Expr]))
(appE [fun : Exp]
      [arg : Exp])
```

- Similar for ExpS

Functions as Values

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 - Function stores the info we need to call it

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 - In some other context
- The value of a function is the code to be run later

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```
(define (subst [toReplace : Symbol]
               [replacedBy : Expr]
               [replaceIn : Expr]) : Expr
  (type-case Exp replaceIn
    ....
    [(lamE var body)
     (lamE var
      (if (symbol=? var toReplace)
          body
          (subst toReplace replacedBy body)))]
  ))
```

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(define (interp expr)
  (type-case Exp interp
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    [(lamE x body)
     (lamV x body)] ))
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- Nothing to do to turn function into a value

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 - Store the expression to be evaluated later

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(define (interp expr)
  (type-case Exp interp
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     [(appE fun arg)
      (type-case Value (interp fun)
        [(lamV var body)
         (let* ([argExp (Value->Exp (interp arg))]
                [subbedBody (subst var argExp body)])
           (interp subbedBody))])
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       (error 'interp "Tried to call non-function")]]])])
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 - Finally, evaluate the substituted body

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 - Get `{+ 3 10}`, finally `(numV 30)`

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- Substitution lets us build new functions at run time based on values to other functions

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- `interp` runs forever

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;; BAD! Don't do this
(define (interp expr
  (type-case Exp expr
    [(cndE test thn els)
      (let ([thenVal (interp thn)]
            [elseVal (interp els)])
        (if (= 0 (checkAndGetNum (interp test)))
            thenVal
            elseVal)))]))
(run ~{if {zero? 0}
          {+ 1 1}
          {let1 f {lam x {x x}} {f f}}})
```

- Loops because it evaluates the untaken branch